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Lab 3.1 Assessing Your Current Level of Cardiorespiratory Endurance

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The 1.5-Mile Run-Walk Test

Equipment

1. A running track or course that is flat and provides exact measurements of up to 1.5 miles
2. A stopwatch, clock, or watch with a second hand

Preparation

You may want to practice pacing yourself prior to taking the test to avoid going too fast at the start and becoming prematurely fatigued. Allow yourself a day or two to recover from your practice run before taking the test.

Instructions

1. Warm up before taking the test. Do some walking, easy jogging, and some stretching exercises.

2. Try to cover the distance as fast as possible without overexerting yourself. If possible, monitor your own time or have someone call out your time at various intervals of the test to determine whether your pace is correct.

3. Record the amount of time, in minutes and seconds, it takes you to complete the 1.5-mile distance.

   Running-Walking Time: 9 min 23 sec

4. Cool down after the test by walking or jogging slowly for about 5 minutes.

Determining Maximal Oxygen Consumption

1. Convert your running time from minutes and seconds to decimal figure. For example, a time of 14 minutes and 25 seconds would be 14 + (25/60), or 14.4 minutes.

   Running-Walking time 9 min + (23/60 sec divided by 60 sec/min) = .38 min

2. Insert your running time in the equation below, where
   T = running time (in minutes)
   VO_{2max} = (483 / T) + 3.5

   VO_{2max} = (483 / 9.38) + 3.5 = 54.99 ml/kg/min
   run-walk time (minutes)

Rating Your Cardiovascular Fitness

Record your VO_{2max} score(s) and the corresponding fitness rating from the table below.

Women	Very Poor	Poor	Fair	Good	Excellent	Superior
Age: 18 - 29	Below 31.6	31.6 - 35.4	35.5 - 39.4	39.5 - 43.9	44.0 - 50.1	Above 50.1
30 - 39	Below 29.9	29.9 - 33.7	33.8 - 36.7	36.8 - 40.9	41.0 - 46.8	Above 46.8
40 - 49	Below 28.0	28.0 - 31.5	31.6 - 35.0	35.1 - 38.8	38.9 - 45.1	Above 45.1
50 - 59	Below 25.5	25.5 - 28.6	28.7 - 31.3	31.4 - 35.1	35.2 - 39.8	Above 39.8
60 - 69	Below 23.7	23.7 - 26.5	26.6 - 29.0	29.1 - 32.2	32.3 - 36.8	Above 36.8
Men						
Age: 18- 29	Below 38.1	38.1- 42.1	42.2 - 45.6	45.7 - 51.0	51.1 - 56.1	Above 56.1
30 - 39	Below 36.7	36.7 - 40.9	41.0 - 44.3	44.4 - 48.8	48.9 - 54.2	Above 54.2
40 - 49	Below 34.6	34.6 - 38.3	38-4 - 42.3	42.4 - 46.7	46.8 - 52.8	Above 52.8
50 - 59	Below 31.1	31.1 - 35.1	35.2 - 38.2	38.3 - 43.2	43.3 - 49.6	Above 49.6
60 - 69	Below 27.4	27.4 - 31.3	31.4 - 34.9	35.0 - 39.4	39.5 - 46.0	Above 46.0

Source: Ratings based on norms from the Cooper Institute for Aerobics Research, Dallas, Texas, The Physical Fitness Specialist Manual, Revised 2002. Used with permission.

Using Your Results

Are you surprised by your rating for cardiovascular fitness?

I'm not surprised. I'm more surprised that it was rated above 50.1 mainly because I'm a sprinter and I have had teammates who’s 2 mile time is in the 9 minutes.

What factors contributed to your score (i.e. environments, psychological,)?

Probably experience, I usually run about 3 miles as a long run day for 400m hurdle training.

List specific strategies to maintain or improve your current score.

SHort runs once a week and long run days once a week. Staying hydrated.